25901533-Answer Key

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCSOC201 - MODERN SOCIOLOGICAL THEORIES
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes. **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A – Short Answer

1. A latent function of education is the formation of social networks among students.
2. Conflict perspective assumes society is marked by inequality and power struggles.
3. Dysfunction weakens stability by disrupting social order.
4. George Herbert Mead was a key theorist of symbolic interactionism.
5. Intended consequences are planned outcomes, while unintended ones are unforeseen results.
6. Individuals acquire behaviour through socialization and interaction.
7. Significant symbols are shared meanings that enable communication.
8. Talcott Parsons is considered the chief architect of structural functionalism.
9. Symbolic interactionism can be studied through observation of social interactions.
10. Domination refers to control exercised by powerful groups over others.
11. Significant symbols reduce misunderstanding by creating shared meanings.
12. Functionalism is criticized for underestimating social conflict.
13. Structure refers to patterned relationships within society.
14. Social environment shapes the self through interaction with others.
15. Linguistic signs consist of the signifier and the signified.
16. Mind is a process of thinking, while self is the awareness of identity.

Part B – Short Essay

17a. Coser viewed conflict as functional for maintaining group cohesion. He argued that conflict can strengthen social bonds and promote adaptation.

17b. Structuralism analyses underlying patterns in language and culture. It reveals deep structures that shape social practices.

18a. Functionalism has its roots in classical sociology, especially Durkheim. It emphasizes stability, order, and integration in society.

18b. Conflict has both positive and negative consequences in society. It can promote social change but may also create instability.

19a. Parsons' voluntaristic theory emphasizes action guided by norms and values. The concept of the unit act explains the basic elements of social action.

19b. Cooley argued that the self develops through social interaction. His “looking-glass self” explains how individuals see themselves through others’ perceptions.

20a. Conflict perspective explains social change through struggles between competing groups. It highlights inequality and power dynamics in society.

20b. Structuralism compares systems like language and kinship to identify patterns. Both are seen as governed by underlying structures.